
PAPERBOY

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 16, 2026

The 10-year Treasury closed at 5.00% — its first close at or above 5% since August 2007 — hours before a Fed decision the market has priced as a hike.

AI

OpenAI puts the three-lab safety talks on the record. The other two labs say nothing.

WHAT HAPPENED

OpenAI's global policy chief Chris Lehane told reporters Tuesday that the company has spent weeks coordinating with Anthropic and Google DeepMind on AI safety, the first on-record confirmation of talks this brief has been tracking since July. Lehane's reasoning, verbatim: "It's better to try to work together to prioritize safety" and "There are many instances over time where companies are trying to help each other on safety" ([Bloomberg wire, 15 Sept](#)). He said OpenAI backs the provision in the FRONTIER Act that would let "independent verification organizations" operate inside frontier labs, and Sam Altman said OpenAI would embed third-party evaluators ([TechCrunch](#)). Anthropic and Google DeepMind did not respond to either outlet. The industry standards body reported alongside this is The Information's sourcing, not Lehane's.

WHAT IT MEANS

This is one company narrating a three-company arrangement, which is not the same as three companies agreeing to one. Lehane's antitrust position — that no government waiver is needed — also quietly contradicts Dario Amodei's pacing essay, which asked for a narrow exemption precisely because coordination on capability restraint looks like collusion. The gap between those two readings is the whole regulatory question.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Anthropic or DeepMind confirms on the record; a bill number and markup date for the FRONTIER Act; METR's eight-week report.

Beijing calls the slowdown campaign self-serving, and says a framework without China is not global

WHAT HAPPENED

Chinese state media answered the Western pacing campaign directly. A China Daily editorial dated 14 September argued that "A global AI-safety framework that excludes China is not quite global," naming Amodei, Altman and Elon Musk, and cast US policy as moving from hardware curbs — chips, lithography, equipment — to software controls as a containment strategy. Foreign Ministry spokesman Guo Jiakun added: "Fearmongering, confrontation and vicious competition will only disrupt the process of global AI governance" ([Bloomberg wire](#), [via republisher](#)). Read through a republisher; Bloomberg is not fetchable here.

WHAT IT MEANS

The editorial is doing something more precise than nationalist noise. It identifies the actual weakness in a voluntary, US-led pacing regime: it binds only the labs that sign it, and the unsigned frontier is roughly six months behind and closing. Every argument for restraint made in Washington this month has been met with the same one-line rebuttal, and nobody has answered it.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any Chinese lab is invited into the standards-body conversation; MOFCOM's distillation rules; the mid-September US-China AI talks Bessent is reported to lead.

SK hynix is reportedly in talks to make memory in America, inside Intel's half-built Ohio plant

WHAT HAPPENED

SK hynix is exploring making memory chips in the United States for the first time, in talks with Intel over two structures: leasing part of Intel's long-delayed Ohio complex, or a joint venture with Intel and large cloud buyers to lock in supply. SK hynix currently produces no memory wafers in the US, though it is building a \$4bn advanced-packaging plant in Indiana. The company said it is "reviewing various options, including additional production bases" and that nothing is decided; Intel declined to comment on the talks ([Korea Herald, 16 Sept](#)). Reuters-originated and single-outlet — unconfirmed. Intel closed Tuesday at \$97.14 and was quoted up 4.75% pre-market Wednesday on the report.

WHAT IT MEANS

Two problems solving each other. Intel has a site it cannot fill and a foundry business short of anchor tenants; SK hynix has HBM demand it cannot serve from Korea fast enough and a tariff exposure it would rather not carry. If a hyperscaler underwrites it, this is the first memory fab commitment on US soil at scale — and the first sign Ohio becomes an asset rather than a write-down.

WATCH NEXT

Any confirmation from either company; Micron's fiscal Q1 on 30 September; September DRAM contract settlements.

Skyworks jumps 13.6% as the Qorvo merger clears down to two jurisdictions

WHAT HAPPENED

Skyworks was Tuesday's standout chip move, closing at \$90.00, up 13.55% ([close, 15 Sept](#)). CEO Phil Brace said the \$22bn Qorvo merger has "entered its final regulatory phases, with approvals now pending in only two remaining jurisdictions," targeting a close within the calendar year and roughly \$500m in cost and revenue synergies; Apple's first foldable iPhone, announced at the line's top price point, is the second catalyst, since Skyworks supplies RF front-end parts into that lineup. Qorvo rose 9.34% on the fixed exchange ratio ([Investing.com](#)).

WHAT IT MEANS

RF has been the least glamorous corner of semiconductors and the one most exposed to a single customer. Consolidating the two largest Apple RF suppliers into one is a bet that scale beats Apple's ability to play them off each other — a bet that only pays if the foldable actually sells units.

WATCH NEXT

Which two jurisdictions remain; a closing date; Apple foldable pre-order data from 16 and 23 October.

The chip tape stabilised while the rest of the market fell

WHAT HAPPENED

Two days after the pacing selloff, semiconductors went up and everything else went down. SOXX closed at \$498.85, +0.29%, against QQQ at \$704.54, -0.65%. Nvidia closed \$212.17 (+0.57%), AMD \$504.20 (+2.19%), Micron \$927.60 (+0.39%), Intel \$97.14 (-0.05%) — all individual closes, [stockanalysis.com](#). Separately, Dutch inference-silicon startup EUCLYD announced a Series A above EUR 200m with Samsung participating — an unusually large first priced round, aimed at the cost of running models rather than training them.

WHAT IT MEANS

Monday was a positioning unwind, not demand destruction, and Tuesday is the evidence: the sector bounced on a day the broad index fell and yields rose. EUCLYD points the same way — money moving from training capacity toward inference cost per token, which is where the margin fight actually is.

WATCH NEXT

Whether AMD follows Intel's 5 October price increase; TSMC September revenue around 10 October; Micron on 30 September.

The 10-year closed at 5.00% — the first close at or above 5% since August 2007

WHAT HAPPENED

On the eve of the FOMC decision the long end finished at a level it has not touched at a close in nineteen years. Treasury's official curve for 15 September: 2-year 4.67%, 10-year 5.00%, 30-year 5.36%, against 4.65/4.97/5.34 on Monday ([Treasury daily yield curve](#)). Note the precision: 5.00 is the first close at or above 5% since 20 August 2007 — not above it — and the October 2023 scare peaked at 4.98%.

Schwab put the hike probability at 92% on the CME FedWatch tool. Kevin Gordon of the Schwab Center: "When we think about the main drivers of inflation—tariffs, energy, and AI capex—none have slowed materially" ([Schwab, 15 Sept](#)).

WHAT IT MEANS

The target range is 3.50–3.75%, set on 29 July, and the market is not arguing about direction any more — only about the 2027 dot. A hike into an energy shock is the Volcker trade, and the bond market has already decided the Fed will take it.

Schwab's Collin Martin offers the other reading: "Treasury yields might not be a problem that needs to be fixed. They are indicative of the economic environment we're in."

WATCH NEXT

The decision and the dot plot today at 2pm ET; the BOJ on 17–18 September; August PCE on 26 September.

Oil back above \$100 on both benchmarks — and Washington says the Saudi pipeline is days from restarting

WHAT HAPPENED

Crude ran hard Tuesday: WTI +2.64% to \$104.10 and Brent +2.14% to \$107.90, both front-month intraday quotes rather than settlements; Schwab had WTI at \$102.88 earlier in the session, a gap of timing rather than dispute. Against that, US Energy Secretary Chris Wright said Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline should be back online on a timeframe that is "still a detailed assessment, but I think it will be measured in days," speaking at a G20 energy meeting in Houston ([Al-Monitor, 15 Sept](#)). The line had been carrying 4-5m barrels a day in recent months as shippers routed around a closed Strait of Hormuz — roughly 4-5% of global supply, against a nameplate capacity near 7m.

WHAT IT MEANS

That 4-5m figure is emergency volume, not normal throughput, which is what makes the restart date load-bearing: with Hormuz shut since March the pipeline is not a secondary route, it is the route. And "days" is an American official's estimate of a Saudi repair; no Aramco statement has put a number on the damage.

WATCH NEXT

An Aramco damage assessment; EIA weekly inventories and diesel; whether Salalah gets a new date.

The tape split: yields up, index down, chips up

WHAT HAPPENED

US equities fell on the hawkish repricing while semiconductors rose. Per TheStreet's Tuesday wrap — single-outlet, and the index levels should be treated as such — the S&P 500 closed -0.45% at 7,585.73, the Dow -0.63% at 52,093.11, the Nasdaq Composite -0.78% at 25,981.57 and the Russell 2000 -0.86% at 2,867.27 ([TheStreet, 15 Sept](#)). No major US earnings landed in the window.

WHAT IT MEANS

Small caps leading the decline and the long end leading yields is the textbook shape of a market pricing tighter policy for longer, not a growth scare. The semiconductor divergence inside a down tape says the AI capex trade is being treated as separate from the rate trade — which holds right up until the 2027 dot says otherwise.

WATCH NEXT

The post-decision reaction this afternoon; whether small caps keep underperforming through the 2027 dot.

Profound raises \$180m at \$1.8bn, seven months after its last round, for getting brands into AI answers

WHAT HAPPENED

Profound, two years old, closed a \$180m Series D at a \$1.8bn valuation co-led by Sequoia and Kleiner Perkins, with Lightspeed, Khosla Ventures and South Park Commons joining. Its \$96m Series C closed less than seven months ago. The company sells answer-engine optimisation — software that tracks and shapes how a brand appears inside AI-generated search answers — and reports 3x revenue growth over six months and more than 1,000 enterprise customers, naming Comcast, Estée Lauder and Walmart ([TechCrunch, 15 Sept](#)).

WHAT IT MEANS

Seven months between a \$96m round and a \$180m round at unicorn pricing is investors underwriting a category rather than a company. The bet is that AEO becomes a permanent marketing line item the way SEO did. The risk is identical to SEO's: the platforms can make the whole discipline obsolete in a single ranking change, and here the platforms are also the labs.

WATCH NEXT

Whether OpenAI or Google ships publisher-facing attribution controls that make third-party AEO tooling redundant.

EUCLYD takes more than EUR 200m in a Series A, with Samsung on the cap table

WHAT HAPPENED

Dutch AI-inference chip startup EUCLYD announced a Series A above EUR 200m with Samsung participating, alongside Somerset Capital Partners, Scaleup Europe Fund/EQT, Innovation Industries, EIFO, imec.xpand, the Brabant Development Agency and Quadri. The company builds compute platforms and memory architecture aimed at the cost of running models — compute, memory bandwidth, electricity and data-centre footprint — rather than training them ([Tech Startups](#), 15 Sept). Aggregator-sourced; the amount and lead structure should be checked against a company announcement.

WHAT IT MEANS

A nine-figure Series A in European silicon, with a memory incumbent inside it, is what the hardware turn looks like when it gets priced. Samsung's presence is the interesting part — a strategic backing an architecture that competes for the same memory-bandwidth budget it sells into.

WATCH NEXT

A company press release confirming the number; whether any named cloud customer emerges.

Evvy raises \$40m; Tuesday's other rounds skew Chinese and physical

WHAT HAPPENED

Evvy, founded in 2021 by Priyanka Jain, Laine Bruzek and Pita Navarro, raised a \$40m Series B led by Catalio Capital Management for at-home vaginal microbiome testing, citing more than 100,000 patients, 3,000 practitioners and 15 peer-reviewed publications ([TechCrunch](#)). Jain: "You can't build precision medicine for women on data sets that never adequately measured female biology in the first place." Of the ten rounds announced Tuesday, most were Chinese and hardware-first: ENCOS took RMB 300m+ Series B for robotic joint modules led by CITIC Goldstone; Yincheng Intelligence and Kangwei Vision took roughly RMB 100m each for logistics robots and semiconductor optical inspection.

WHAT IT MEANS

The US megadeal cadence has not resumed — Profound aside, the day's volume was Asian, hardware and mid-sized. That pattern has now held for several sessions and is worth watching as more than noise.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any YC hardware name clears a priced Series A before December; the next US round above \$200m.

Crypto market-structure legislation dies in the Senate, 49-50

WHAT HAPPENED

Cloture on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633 — the CLARITY Act, which would split digital-asset oversight between the SEC and CFTC — was rejected 49 to 50 on roll call 234 at 2:19pm Tuesday ([Senate roll call 234](#)). Sixty were needed; it did not clear fifty. Four Republicans crossed — Collins, Hawley, Moran and Tillis — and not one Democrat or independent voted yes. The break came over a conflict-of-interest title. Warren called the Republican "final offer" on ethics "a weak fig leaf that will do nothing to stop him from making his next \$1.4 billion in crypto profits"; SEC chairman Paul Atkins said that "with or without that legislation, this Administration will deliver for American investors and technological innovators" ([Axios](#)). Bitcoin fell to under \$76,000, Coinbase more than 8%, Strategy 5%.

WHAT IT MEANS

Three years of lobbying failed on a margin no whip operation can close, because the objection is not to market structure — it is to writing rules that touch the President's own crypto holdings. Atkins' line is the plan: regulate by SEC rulemaking instead, which is faster, narrower and reversible by the next administration.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Lummis can reopen it with a standalone ethics title; SEC rulemaking on digital-asset custody.

Three hours later, the same Senate advanced the college-athlete bill 74-24

WHAT HAPPENED

At 5:00pm Tuesday, roll call 235 invoked cloture on S. 4668, the student-athlete name, image and likeness bill, 74 to 24 ([Senate roll call 235](#)). Earlier that day roll call 233 confirmed Matthew Byrne to the Southern District of Ohio, 52-45.

Separately, the Lindsey Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act reaches the House floor this week and is splitting Democrats: it would let the administration impose tariffs of up to 100% on the five largest buyers of Russian oil. Meeks, Beyer and Neal, jointly: "This bill would dramatically expand presidential tariff authorities while failing to mandate sanctions on Russia." It passed the Senate 86-11 last month.

WHAT IT MEANS

Seventy-four votes for college sports and forty-nine for crypto, in the same afternoon, says this Senate can still legislate — just not on anything touching the President's business interests. The Graham bill puts House Democrats in the reverse bind: the sanctions they want, delivered through the tariff power they have spent two years litigating.

WATCH NEXT

The House vote on the Graham bill; whether the tariff delegation survives the rule fight.

CBO puts the Iran war at \$38bn and adds half a point to its own 2027 inflation forecast

WHAT HAPPENED

The Congressional Budget Office published its cost estimate for the Iran campaign on 15 September: "As of August 1, 2026, the armed conflict with Iran has cost DoD approximately \$38 billion" ([CBO, publication 62756](#)). The run rate is conditional: about \$2bn a month at May-June intensity, \$3bn at July intensity. CBO now puts year-over-year PCE inflation in the first quarter of 2027 half a percentage point higher than it projected in February — a revision against its own forecast, not a standalone claim. Rebuilding the interceptor inventory "would probably take at least five years."

WHAT IT MEANS

The cost of the war stated by the scorekeeper rather than by either party, landing the morning of a Fed decision. Half a point on the 2027 forecast is roughly the difference between one more hike and two. The interceptor line is the more serious number: a five-year magazine-depth problem constrains every other commitment, including Taiwan.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the estimate surfaces in Fed commentary this afternoon; the supplemental; FY27 munitions lines.

Ukraine claims ground at Lyman as Russia runs 200 drones overnight

WHAT HAPPENED

ISW's 15 September assessment has Ukrainian forces advancing in the Lyman direction and against the Russian salient northwest of it, with the 3rd Army Corps striking Russian logistics and fuel under what Kyiv calls Operation Vivaldi — enough, ISW judges, to disrupt Russia's wider encirclement of the Fortress Belt. Russia launched 200 drones overnight; Ukraine struck Russian oil and defence-industrial targets. Zelensky again said he would accept a mutual ceasefire on energy infrastructure. In the Baltic, a Russian frigate fired flares at a Danish helicopter on routine surveillance, and ISW notes European sabotage attempts on 14–15 September matching Russian methods while stating plainly that Russian involvement is unconfirmed ([Kyiv Post, 15 Sept](#)). Operational claims here are Ukraine's own account, relayed by ISW, and are not independently verified.

WHAT IT MEANS

Lyman is the first place in months where Ukraine is shaping the map rather than absorbing pressure, and it is doing it by striking fuel and logistics rather than by mass. The Baltic incidents are the other half of the same campaign — pressure applied where NATO's response threshold is undefined.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the Lyman salient holds through the week; Toronto on 28–29 September; the still-unpublished terms of Trump's claimed energy truce.

Israel says it killed Hamas's Rafah Brigade commander; nine militaries met in Germany

WHAT HAPPENED

The IDF and Shin Bet said they killed Nael Abu Obeid, commander of Hamas's Rafah Brigade and head of its operations division, in a strike in southern Gaza — the Israeli military's account of its own operation, not independently verified.

Palestinian media reported two killed in Khan Younis including an eight-year-old girl, fourteen wounded — Palestinian-sourced figures. Military chiefs from Israel, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, Jordan and Egypt met in Germany on the Iran war and regional security, according to Israeli officials — no confirmation from any Gulf participant. In Lebanon, the US ambassador toured Lebanese-army "pilot zones" near the Israeli border under the June withdrawal agreement ([Times of Israel liveblog, 15 Sept](#)).

WHAT IT MEANS

A nine-nation military meeting including Israel and four Gulf states would be the war's most significant regional realignment — which is exactly why its sourcing to Israeli officials alone matters. If Riyadh or Abu Dhabi confirm it, the Iran war has built a coordination structure two years of normalisation diplomacy could not.

WATCH NEXT

Any Gulf confirmation of the Germany meeting; the Iran Panel of Experts report on 27 September; Israel's election on 27 October.

Merz books a post-election showdown with his own party for Sunday night

WHAT HAPPENED

Friedrich Merz has booked a CDU executive committee meeting for immediately after Sunday's Berlin and Mecklenburg-Vorpommern state elections, seeking public assurances of support amid open speculation about a challenge ([The Local, 15 Sept](#)). The numbers explain the nerves: in Berlin the CDU is polling level with Die Linke, in Mecklenburg-Vorpommern it could fall as low as 7%, and the AfD is expected to do well in both. A Forsa poll has 10% satisfied with his performance. Elsewhere, Sweden's count has not moved: SVT still shows 95% counted at 6,326 of 6,626 districts, left bloc 176, Tidö parties 173, against a 175 threshold.

WHAT IT MEANS

A chancellor scheduling his own confidence test before the votes are counted is pricing the result. Two state elections cannot remove him, but 7% in a state the CDU once governed hands his critics an argument the state premiers cannot ignore. The AfD does not need to win either race to win the week.

WATCH NEXT

Berlin and Mecklenburg-Vorpommern on 20 September and the CDU executive meeting after; von der Leyen's State of the Union today; Sweden's final count around 21 September.

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TechCrunch — Profound raises \$180m at \$1.8bn

TechCrunch — Evvy raises \$40m Series B

Tech Startups — funding roundup, 15 September